

LaNya Hood

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AI/ML Engineer · Human-Centered Data & AI · University of Michigan, Class of 2026

Profile

Emerging AI/ML engineer with hands-on experience in multi-agent systems, RAG pipelines, data engineering, and responsible AI — developed through academic work at the University of Michigan, industry internships, and entrepreneurial projects since 2018. Passionate about building AI that drives real-world impact for underrepresented communities and mission-driven organizations.

Education

The University of Michigan – Ann Arbor | B.G.S

Expected Graduation: 2026

- **Concentration:** Human-Centered Data & AI
- **Extracurriculars:** National Society of Black Engineers, ColorStack, Black@SI, Black Student Union, BlackGen Capital
- **Volunteering Hours:** 180+

Work Experience

AI Training Contractor

March 2026 – Present

Handshake AI

- Process and evaluate audio, visual, and text data to train multimodal AI systems for Project Hedgehog.
- Provide structured feedback that improves model accuracy and generalization across diverse content formats.

Student Brand Ambassador

Aug 2025 – Present

Adobe

- Teach fellow students to leverage Adobe Creative Cloud tools to support academic and professional goals.
- Plan and execute workshops, creative sessions, and campus events to drive engagement with Adobe products.
- Market events and programs to increase student awareness and adoption of Adobe tools.

Leasing Agent

Aug 2025 – Present

American Campus Communities – Willowtree Apartments & Towers

- Conduct personalized property tours for prospective residents; serve as primary contact for current residents resolving leasing and maintenance inquiries.
- Process lease applications, verify tenant documentation, and coordinate move-in/move-out procedures to ensure smooth resident transitions.
- Maintain occupancy targets by following up with prospects and converting leads through relationship-based sales techniques.
- Collaborate with management to execute digital marketing and social media campaigns, promoting resident engagement and brand visibility.
- Track leasing activity and resident data using property management software to support reporting and operational decisions.

Data & Operations Consultant, Intern

May 2025 – Aug 2025

Sandbox Services

- Integrated AI-driven insights and forecasting tools to optimize user engagement and operational efficiency.
- Conducted user research and feature design sessions with C-suite executives to align UI/UX improvements with business needs.
- Built automated dashboards and data visualizations to surface actionable insights and inform strategic decision-making.

Data Specialist, Intern

June 2024 – December 2024

University of Michigan College of Engineering

- Maintained and optimized centralized databases, ensuring data integrity, accuracy, and security across systems.
- Supported cloud-based operations in AWS, streamlining data processing and storage workflows.
- Diagnosed and reported technical and equipment issues, improving system reliability and uptime.

IT Project Engineer, Contractor

June 2023 – August 2023

MacroConnect

- Provided end-user support and network troubleshooting for K-12, government, and business clients.
- Deployed and configured servers, firewalls, routers, and wireless networks to enhance infrastructure performance.
- Conducted ethical hacking exercises and security assessments to identify and address system vulnerabilities.

Detroit Academy of Arts and Sciences

- Designed a digital inventory tracking system, improving data collection speed and accuracy.
- Partnered with the CFO to identify cost-saving measures and improve overall operational efficiency.

Leadership & Entrepreneurship

Founder – Lead Photographer & Editor

May 2018 – Present

Hood Photography

- Develop and edit professional photos using Canon equipment and AI-driven tools in Adobe Photoshop.
- Leverage OpenAI platforms for pricing simulations to deliver competitive, fair pricing for clients.
- Manage all marketing, bookings, payments, and contracts through digital platforms.
- Currently developing an AI chatbot (LangChain & OpenAI) for client scheduling, pricing, and FAQs.

Co-Founder, Co-Lead of Partnerships & Outreach

July 2024 – May 2026

BIPOC Builders

- Developed and executed partnership strategies to expand organizational influence and growth opportunities.
- Created digital tracking systems for outreach metrics to measure success and continuously refine strategy.

Key Projects

NeighborGrid | *In Progress* — 35%

Data and project management platform for government agencies and non-profits. Integrates with existing tools, centralizes operational data, and is fully customizable to each organization's workflows.

KNect | *In Progress* — 80%

University resource platform connecting BIPOC, low-income, and underrepresented students with scholarships, mentorship, career resources, and peer community.

Photography Business Chatbot | *In Progress* — 65%

AI-powered chatbot for Hood Photography built with LangChain and OpenAI APIs; handles client scheduling, pricing inquiries, and FAQs.

Multi-Agent Fact-Checking System | *SI 376* · Week 14

4-agent LangGraph pipeline (Retriever → Skeptic → Verifier → Explainer) for collaborative evidence-grounded fact-checking using RoBERTa-large-MNLI and message passing.

RAG Fact-Checking Pipeline | *SI 376* · Week 12

End-to-end RAG system combining BM25 sparse retrieval and dense sentence embeddings with NLI-based verification against Wikipedia evidence (FEVER dataset). Evaluated with Recall@k.

Single Agent (ReAct) | *SI 376* · Week 13

Adaptive ReAct agent that evaluates retrieval quality, retries with alternate strategies, and abstains when confidence is low — powered by RoBERTa-large-MNLI.

Baseline Classification & Regression | *SI 376* · Weeks 4–5

TF-IDF + Logistic Regression classifier and Ridge regression models on FEVER data. Compared sparse vs. dense HuggingFace embeddings; evaluated with F1, MSE, MAE, and R².

Shark Tank Deal Prediction | *Stats 250* · Project 2

Logistic regression model predicting deal likelihood across 495 Shark Tank pitches (Seasons 1–6) using equity, valuation, and pitch variables.

TED Talks Popularity Analysis | *Stats 250* · Project 1

Statistical analysis of 382 TED Talks identifying key viewership drivers across speaker type, category, duration, and engagement.

Soccer Team Rankings System | *C++ Project*

OOP C++ program parsing roster data into PlayerClass/TeamClass objects, sorting by points, and generating formatted leaderboard output across multiple header and source files.

Lawn Mowing Time Calculator | *C++ Project*

C++ console program computing mow time from user-input lawn/house dimensions and walking speed with multi-step unit conversions.

Reece Chatbot | *Personal Project*

Conversational AI partner using rule-based matching, pattern recognition, and randomized response prompting.

AI for Efficiency | *Personal Project*

AI automation system for summarizing tasks and auto-generating reports, reducing manual administrative overhead.

Data Ethics & AI Law Case Study | Academic Project

Evaluated AI practices and organizational data policies using legal frameworks and landmark cases in AI law.

Technical Skills

Languages & Data: Python, R, SQL, PowerShell, C++, Machine Learning, APIs, Data Visualization, Forecasting

AI & ML: LLMs, Generative AI, RAG, Multi-Agent Systems, LangChain, LangGraph, Prompt Engineering, Responsible AI, NLI, Model Training, Predictive Modeling

Frameworks & Tools: LangChain, LangGraph, OpenAI Codex, Google Gemini, Vibe Coding, Claude Code, AWS, Microsoft Azure, RStudio, Jupyter Notebook, Visual Studio, Excel, Google Workspace, Adobe Photoshop

Cloud & Platforms: AWS, Microsoft Azure, Google Workspace, Excel, MS PowerPoint

Specialties: UX Optimization, Workflow Automation, Dashboard Development, Data Governance, Data Privacy & Security, Operational Efficiency

Certifications

- **Google AI Essentials** | Coursera / Google | 2024 | [View Certificate](#)
- **Microsoft Azure Essentials Professional Certificate** | LinkedIn Learning / Microsoft | 2024 | [View Certificate](#)
- **Google AI Professional Certificate** | Google / Coursera | *In Progress*
- **Docker Foundations Professional Certificate** | Docker | *In Progress*